

Traceability Trail Check

Pick one recent job. Walk it from raw material to delivery and mark where you can prove each link today. Wherever you cannot, you have found a gap worth closing. Most trails break at a handover, not at a single record.

Job / order ref:

Date walked:

Completed by:

Item description:

WALK THE CHAIN, LINK BY LINK

Link in the trail	Can you evidence it?
Raw material certificate held (heat / batch number recorded)	Y / N / Gap
Goods-in / receipt record, linked to the delivery	Y / N / Gap
A unique material reference assigned on receipt	Y / N / Gap
In-process and manufacturing records carry that reference	Y / N / Gap
Inspection and test results linked to the same item	Y / N / Gap
Certificate of conformity / final release record	Y / N / Gap
Despatch / delivery record ties back to the item	Y / N / Gap
Named owner for retaining these records, and for how long	Y / N / Gap

WHERE DID THE TRAIL BREAK?

Note the first point where you could not follow the reference through. That handover, usually between two systems or two people, is where to focus first.

ONE ACTION TO CLOSE THE BIGGEST GAP